# People can respond and act

Schedules continue; special events can prompt a short thought and a temporary intention.




Actual local-model reply from fojuce: ?I am gathering wild plants for food and materials.? The optional panel shows current activity, condition, thought and intention. Captured before the final name-capitalization touch-up (Fojuce / Janapsip).

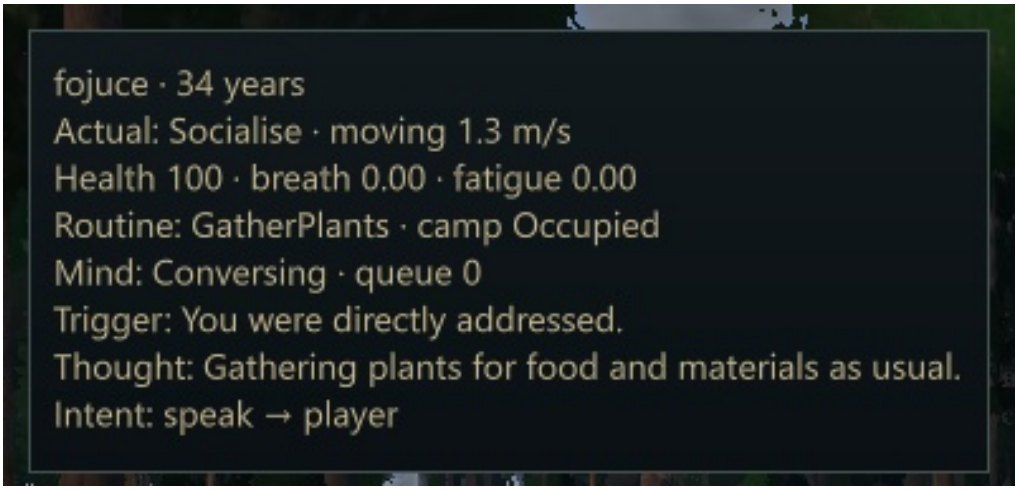
| Try it | What happens |
|---|---|
| Look at a tribal NPC and press E | Type a message, then Enter. The NPC listens immediately; the model replies asynchronously. Enter opens another message while that person remains nearby. |
| /npcthoughts on \| off | Inspect the aimed, selected or nearest resident: actual activity/speed, health, breath/fatigue, normal routine, current plan and short fictional thought. |
| /npcai status \| on \| off | Inspect or disable the local model. Ordinary schedules continue independently. Settings live in the shared per-user NPC cache. |

**Verified:** 17 Core mind assertions and 17 actual game checks: interaction, immediate listening, real replies, physical approach before speech, rest/resume, memory and owned-host cleanup. Another 120 identity/selection/save assertions include capitalization checks for twelve generated residents.

**Current limit:** replies are text in English translation. The small model can still invent incidental details; it cannot grant items or perform unsupported actions. Full-context CPU replies can be slow: the final native reply took 22.05 seconds. No new FPS claim is made.

# Small, bounded decisions

One shared local model; no world-wide NPC thinking loop.




Actual debug panel cropped from the same game frame. ?Thought? is a generated character intention; actual activity is read from the live actor.

| Part | Implemented behavior |
|---|---|
| Triggers | Direct speech; nearby NPC address; injury; one observer noticing an unfamiliar visitor per community. Ordinary movement does not request inference. |
| Budget | One request in flight; queue of eight, with direct speech priority. Passive events have cooldowns. A visitor can trigger at most one background request per 20 seconds across nearby communities. |
| Context | Actual identity, age, band, culture/language, known techniques, family links, current work/condition, nearby targets and short memories. |
| Execution | Approach, speak, wait, rest, flee or resume. Only supplied target identities are accepted. Existing navigation moves the actor; urgent group alarms override the model. |
| Memory | Up to twelve short records per encountered person, saved with local world state. Live action plans are temporary and expire back to the routine. |
| Local runtime | Qwen3-4B-Instruct-2507 Q4_K_M, llama.cpp b12211. Two low-priority CPU threads, no GPU offload. Loaded only on the first event. A Windows job binds host lifetime to the game. |

The 0.8B and 2B trials were rejected for confused speakers or unsupported details. Six structured 4B smoke cases returned valid decisions; the final packaged-game conversation was inspected separately. This remains a prototype dialogue model, not a complete NPC reasoning system.

**Rebuild inputs:** pinned model/runtime hashes and licenses in assets/npc-ai/runtime.json; setup-npc-ai.py installs the shared cache; check-npc-model.py repeats the CPU model cases. Full test receipts are in assets/verification/npc-minds-20261108.json.

**Primary sources:** Qwen model card / Apache-2.0 license; llama.cpp server / MIT license.